Ambassador Pickring. 12:00.

Chairman Berman. 12:00, okay. All right.

General Jones?

General Jones. 12:30.

Chairman Berman. We are now voting on—actually this is a resolution out of this committee on the Georgia-Russia issue so I think I have to recess so we can cast our vote. I am very depressed by the situation we face right now because I do not know that we are going to get back here much before 12 o'clock. We will come back. We will vote and I am going to miss the motion to reconsider the vote by this, if you are. We are going to go and just vote. We will be right back.

[Recess.]

Chairman Berman. I will be the last to leave this room now, I do not care what they vote on. But I apologize.

I am going to recognize myself to ask a question to give, I know, Ambassadors, I know you have to leave, and then one question and then I will recognize Congressman Royce and Costa. And then to the extent anybody is still here I will come back for the rest of my questions. But it is a real specific one.

Given these recent reports, and you have all talked about this issue, of negotiating truces between the Government of, the new Government of Pakistan and some irreconcilable terrorist elements such as Baitullah Mehsud, how do you believe the United States should react? What steps can we take to dissuade the Pakistani military and civilian leadership from making such deals which will undoubtedly lead to greater cross-border attacks on United States troops? To what extent do these deals represent discord—and I think there was a reference to this in one of your testimonies—to what extent do these deals represent discord between the Pakistani military and civilian leadership on how to instill political reform in the FATA? Install and instill. So?

Ambassador Holbrooke. Mr. Chairman, you are asking a question nobody really has an answer to, including, and I stress this, the administration. They do not really know nor do we exactly what the nature of these deals will add up to. There is a difference of opinion over Baitullah's own role in the assassination of Benazir Bhutto, for example.

So I would like to suggest a different approach to the issue which is to deal with the—not to deal with this specific problem out of context which will inevitably lead to a United States-Pakistan Government friction, but to deal with it with a comprehensive plan for the tribal areas. We do not have that now, as the GAO report makes clear, as my own trip made clear, as the comments of my two colleagues made clear.

The Embassy in Kabul and the Embassy in Pakistan reflect the differing views of Kabul and Islamabad on that issue. President Karzai will tell you that everything that is going wrong in Afghanistan is Pakistan's fault. The ISI, with which I spent a morning, gave me chapter and verse on how they turned over certain number of terrorists to the Afghan Government at the request of Karzai and half of them were then released. So you can go back and forth between Islamabad and Kabul forever in this argument; it is a bitter anger between the two governments. And I hope that the new political situation in Pakistan will allow an American-sponsored reconciliation between Kabul and Islamabad.

But to your point, we need a massive economic program not this pathetic little $750 million over 5 years, as I said earlier half of which will never leave the United States. We need to regard above all Afghanistan and Pakistan as a single theater of operations, in the

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